cognizant

CIS INFRA · INTERNAL OFFERING PROPOSAL · FOR SENIOR LEADERSHIP REVIEW

Azure AI Platform Portfolio

Five defined CIS Infra offerings for the Azure AI platform: leadership chooses which to test

Master portfolio view for decks 01 to 05 · US, Europe, UK and Middle East pursuits

PROPOSED OFFERING

Pick from five defined offerings and fund a 90-day test

Problem Customers scale AI agents on platforms nobody owns end to end: capacity, cost, control and operations.

Offer Five CIS Infra offerings: assess, build, control traffic, govern agents and run. Each sells alone or in sequence.

Outcome Governed Azure AI platforms in production, with recurring CIS Infra revenue from operations.

Value Customers reach production faster with measured cost; Microsoft gains Azure consumption; we gain services.

Decision requested

- Choose which offerings to test: one, several or all five
- Name a sponsor and owner for each
- Fund a 90-day validation with stop rules

Limit: Rates, budgets and sponsors are inputs required. Fee bands use an illustrative $1,000 per role day.

Agent sprawl, model churn and AI rules create 2026 demand

Agent control planes are GA

Agent 365 has been generally available since 1 May 2026, so agent governance is now a budget line.

Source: Microsoft Security blog

Models retire every few months

gpt-4.1 retires 14 Apr 2027 and gpt-5.4 on 2 Sep 2027. Capacity and routing must keep moving.

Source: Foundry retirement schedule

Regulation has dates

EU AI Act high-risk duties apply from 2 Dec 2027 (Annex III); DORA has applied since 17 Jan 2025.

Sources: Orrick (third party; EUR-Lex text not verified); DORA: EUR-Lex

Who buys

CIO or AI platform leader with the CISO delegate, FinOps lead and IT service owner; CFO or head of operations for business cases.

What triggers the purchase

Agents moving to production; unexplained AI spend; an audit or incident; a Microsoft licence or capacity decision.

No pipeline or customer demand is claimed. Account shortlist and qualification scorecard: appendix Q1.

ESTIMATE, NOT APPROVED

Each option suits a goal; we would start with 04 and 03

Offering	First sale	First revenue	Good choice if you want
04 FinOps Assessment	$20k to $40k	4 to 6 weeks	A fast, low-risk start
01 Landing Zone	$15k to $30k, then $140k to $220k	3 to 5 weeks	Largest one-time deals
03 AI Gateway	$10k to $20k, then $45k to $90k	2 to 4 weeks	Broad, repeatable demand
02 Agent Governance	$15k to $25k, pilot later	3 to 4 weeks	Edge, once proven
05 Managed Operations	$30k to $60k a month	4 to 8 weeks	Recurring revenue

Author recommendation

Start with 04 and 03.

Fastest to revenue and lowest internal build effort (A9). Pair 03 with a 01 assessment where no landing zone exists. Run the 02 PoC in parallel.

Leadership decides.

Note: Fee bands use an illustrative $1,000 per role day, not a Cognizant rate. Detail: appendix A1; business case: appendix A8.

PROPOSED VIEW

Revenue this year from 04 and 03; 02 is the bet to prove

Horizon 1: earn now
0 to 6 months

04 FinOps Assessment short, fixed scope

03 AI Gateway needs a landing zone

Horizon 2: build the base
6 to 18 months

01 Landing Zone largest one-time deals

05 Managed Operations recurring revenue

Horizon 3: prove the bet
after the PoC

02 Agent Governance differentiator once proven

Kill-switch PoC internal, funding requested

Time and maturity

PROPOSED BOUNDARIES

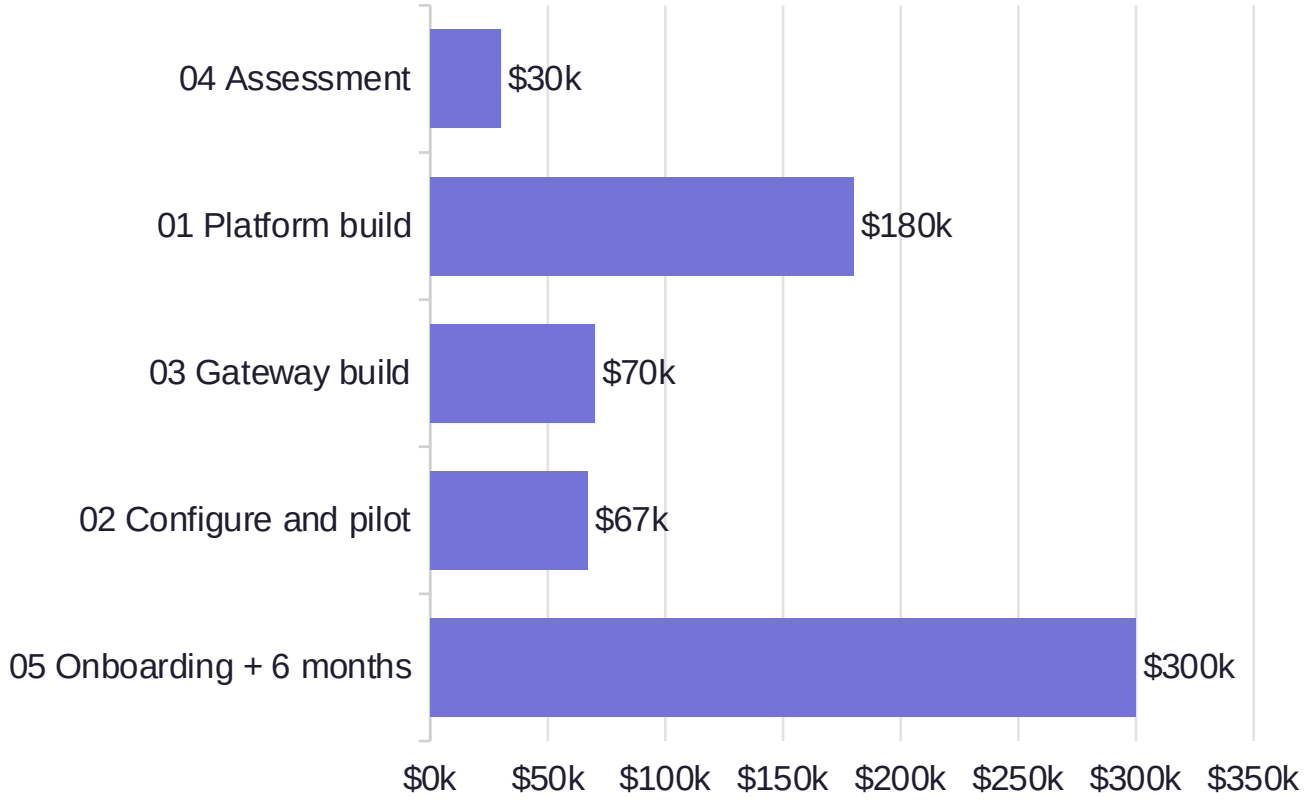
M365 Copilot stays with M365 and D365; we own the Azure side

Cognizant M365 and D365 teams	Shared: joint rules apply	CIS Infra offerings 01 to 05
Microsoft 365 Copilot Microsoft 365 apps (M365 team, to confirm)	**Copilot Studio** Power Platform admins it; we govern its agents	**Foundry and AI landing zone** offering 01
Copilot in Dynamics 365 D365 team, to confirm	**Agent 365 and Entra** Security owns policy; we implement	**API Management and API Center** offering 03
Adoption and change licences, rollout, training	**Purview readiness** Security leads; we supply inputs	**Governance, FinOps, operations** offerings 02, 04, 05

Decision: Open: the M365 versus D365 Copilot split and the joint-deal lead (register D1, owners named).

HYPOTHETICAL

One customer buying all five: $647k in year one, $540k after



Portfolio size

accounts × attach rate × deal size

Accounts and attach rate: input required from account leadership.

Investment, payback and margin structure: appendix A9 and A10.

Limit: Hypothetical deal, illustrative rate. Customer Azure and licence spend is separate and goes to Microsoft.

CLAIMS TO VALIDATE

Our edge is testable: five claims, each with its proof

Differentiator (claim to validate)	Evidence needed	Status
Built on Microsoft AI Landing Zone accelerators	Working lab build and reuse saving measured	To prove
Configure Agent 365 and Foundry first, build only gaps	One pilot with build-versus-buy log	To prove
Kill switch tested before it is sold	PoC with measured stop time per runtime	To prove
One run model with clear tower lanes	Signed tower agreements and first service report	To prove
Cost evidence from day one	One assessment memo accepted by a customer	To prove

Limit: Benchmark firms are public positioning only, not proof of quality or price. Battlecard: appendix A6.

CHECKED 11 OCT 2026

Microsoft gains consumption; we gain co-sold services

Consumption for Microsoft	Services co-sell	Funding and assessments
Governed platforms move AI workloads into production, which grows Azure use	Needs a Solutions partner designation, a specialization or Azure Expert MSP	Azure Accelerate where eligible for discovery; we charge for the decision memo
Owner: offering owners	Owner: alliance team to confirm status	Owner: alliance team, per customer

Decision: Specializations to confirm: AI Platform on Microsoft Azure; AI Apps on Microsoft Azure. No funding assumed in any price.

INPUTS REQUIRED

Decide today: which offerings, who owns them, what budget

Offering	Budget	Sponsor, owner	Stop at day 45 if	Success by day 90
04 Assessment	Input	Input	no data access	two assessments signed
03 AI Gateway	Input	Input	no qualified account	one readiness sold
01 Landing Zone	Input	Input	lab build fails	lab built, one deal qualified
02 Governance	Input	Input	PoC fails a K4 test	PoC passed, stop time measured
05 Managed Ops	Input	Input	no tower agreements	agreements signed, one onboarding

Decision: Input: budget and sponsor from leadership; headcount from the delivery lead. Day-30 checkpoint; register D1.

APPENDIX

Portfolio appendix

Offering cards, ownership matrix, joint motion, risks, sizing, investment and margin, internal positioning, Microsoft alignment, governance, sign-off, third-party risk, responsible AI, inputs required, security, regulation and sources.

Appendix index

13 **A1** Offering cards

14 **A2** Capability ownership matrix

15 **A3** Joint-motion rules and cannibalisation check

16 **A4** Portfolio risks

17 **A6** Competitor battlecard

18 **A7** Internal positioning

19 **A8** Opportunity sizing

20 **A9** Investment and payback

21 **A10** Margin structure and revenue recognition

22 **A11** Microsoft sales motion alignment

23 **A12** Sign-off status

24 **A13** Offering governance

25 **A14** Third-party risk answer set

26 **A15** Responsible AI controls

27 **A16** Inputs required summary

28 **E1** Combined estimate assumptions

29 **Q1** Qualification scorecard and account shortlist

30 **SEC1** AI threat model and controls

31 **SEC2** Regulation and EU AI Act roles

32 **SEC3** Security services and owners

33 **G1** Glossary

34 **D1** Decision and approval register

35 **S1** Sources and verification dates

36 **S1b** Sources and verification dates (continued)

Offering cards: buyer, trigger, entry package, value

Offering	Main buyer	Trigger	Entry package (role days)	Customer value metric
04 FinOps Assessment	FinOps lead, CFO delegate	Spend growing; PTU or licence decision	Assessment, 20 to 40	Cost per useful AI task
01 Landing Zone	Cloud platform owner	First production AI workload	Assess, 15 to 30	Weeks from approval to first production workload
03 AI Gateway	Platform or API owner	Many teams calling models; keys in apps	Readiness, 10 to 20	Share of AI calls governed and attributed
02 Agent Governance	AI platform leader, CISO delegate	Agent sprawl; audit request	Coverage assessment, 15 to 25	Agents with an owner; stop time measured
05 Managed Operations	IT service owner	AI workload entering production	Onboarding, 20 to 40	Incidents resolved inside target

One owner per capability: no offering claims the same work

Capability	01	02	03	04	05
Landing zone, network, identity plumbing	Builds				Operates
Agent registry, catalogue, reviews		Builds			Operates
Kill switch (containment)	Network inputs	Builds and proves	Gateway enforcement		Operates drills
Gateway policies, API Center			Builds		Operates
Chargeback and showback			Builds the data	Designs the model	Runs reports
Capacity and cost decisions			Routing rules	Designs	Monthly review
Monthly service and cost review				Supplies method	Runs

PROPOSED, TO AGREE

Joint motion with M365 and D365: one team, one lead

Topic	Proposed rule	Owner to agree
Deal lead	Team with the largest first priced work package leads; account leader confirms	Practice leads
Copilot ownership split	M365 team: Copilot in Microsoft 365 apps; D365 team: Copilot in Dynamics 365 (to confirm)	M365 and D365 leads
Handoffs to CIS Infra	Identity, network, Purview readiness inputs, Azure-hosted agents and backends	CIS Infra with M365 lead
Revenue credit	By priced work package per team; shared costs allocated once	Finance
One-team narrative	One deck, one sponsor, one plan: Copilot adoption on a governed Azure platform	Account leader
Cannibalisation check	Existing Cognizant infrastructure or managed service accounts: extend by change control, never a rival bid	Account leader with delivery

Portfolio risks and how we handle them

Risk	Effect	How we handle it	Owner
Tower commitments unsigned	Offers cannot be delivered end to end	Signed tower agreements during validation	CIS Infra leadership
Overlap with M365, D365 and AI practices	Several Cognizant teams pitch one customer	Joint-motion rules (A3) and internal positioning (A7)	Practice leads
No approved rates	Bands cannot become quotes	Finance sets rates and attribution	Finance
Microsoft features change	Preview features shift or slip	GA for production; recheck before quotes	Offering owners
Kill switch unproven	Containment promised but not delivered	Not in committed scope until the PoC passes	Offering owner 02
Too many offerings at once	Effort spread thin	Leadership chooses; stop rules at day 45	CIS Infra leadership

Competitor battlecard and objection responses

Firm	Public positioning	Lesson for our pitch
Accenture and Avanade	Agentic factory, industry workflows	Tie assets to an operational buyer
TCS	Persona-based Copilot rollout	Repeatable role and integration patterns
KPMG	Copilot, custom agents, governance	Connect trust controls to value
EPAM	AI/Run, agentic engineering	Show reusable assets and test evidence
EY	Industry engineering, change	Include process change and value owners
PwC	Azure quickstart, responsible AI	Named packages need real assets
Deloitte	End-to-end Microsoft transformation	Connect technology to operating model
Wipro	Industry IP, agent marketplace	Make integration reuse visible

"You are only infrastructure."

Agents fail on identity, network, cost and stop paths. That is our scope, and it is testable.

"Why not just use Microsoft's tools?"

We do. We deploy and configure Microsoft tools first so customers adopt them faster, and build only what is missing.

"Big partners have more references."

Start with a 4 to 6 week assessment and judge us on its evidence.

OWNERS TO CONFIRM

Inside Cognizant: where CIS Infra adds infrastructure depth

Cognizant offering (public, per V3 C1 to C8)	Leads on	Where CIS Infra adds	Owner
Agent Foundry	Agentic AI at enterprise scale	Landing zone, gateway, governance and operations for its agents	To confirm
Enterprise agentic AI and multi-agent services	Agent design and build	Runtime controls, containment and FinOps	To confirm
Neuro AI Engineering, Enterprise Core, Decisioning	AI engineering platforms	Azure hosting, identity, network, cost controls	To confirm
Microsoft Business Group and AI Operations Assistant	Microsoft business apps and Copilot	Azure-side platform and agent operations	To confirm
Microsoft Copilot services (M365 and D365 teams)	Copilot rollout and adoption	Identity, network, Purview inputs, Azure backends	To confirm

Limit: Descriptions summarise public positioning only. Confirm every boundary with its owner before external use.

INPUTS REQUIRED

Sizing the opportunity: formula ready, inputs needed

Offering	Target accounts	Attach rate	Average first deal (illustrative)	Revenue formula
04 Assessment	Input: account leadership	Input: account leadership	$30k	Y1 = A × B × C
01 Landing Zone	Input: account leadership	Input: account leadership	$22k assess, $180k build	Y1 = A × B × C
03 AI Gateway	Input: account leadership	Input: account leadership	$15k readiness, $68k build	Y1 = A × B × C
02 Agent Governance	Input: account leadership	Input: account leadership	$20k assess, $45k configure, $22k pilot	Y1 = A × B × C
05 Managed Operations	Input: account leadership	Input: account leadership	$45k a month	Y1 = A × B × C × months

Note: A accounts, B attach rate, C deal. Year 3 = sum of yearly A × B × C plus expansion into 01 and 05. $1,000 per role day.

ESTIMATE, INPUTS REQUIRED

What Cognizant invests before the first sale, and payback

Offering	Internal asset to build first	Build effort (role days; $ at $1,000)	Cash items	Payback
04 Assessment	Cost model, method, memo template	15 to 25 ($15k to $25k)	Input required: Finance	Investment ÷ margin per deal
03 AI Gateway	Policy library, test harness	25 to 40 ($25k to $40k)	Lab Azure spend: input required	Investment ÷ margin per deal
01 Landing Zone	Lab build of AI landing zone on AVM	30 to 50 ($30k to $50k)	Lab Azure spend: input required	Investment ÷ margin per deal
02 Agent Governance	PoC 25 to 45; catalogue 15 to 25	40 to 70 ($40k to $70k)	Agent 365 test licences: input required	Investment ÷ margin per deal
05 Managed Operations	Runbooks, tooling, roster setup	20 to 40 ($20k to $40k)	Roster funding: input required	Investment ÷ monthly margin
All	Enablement and certifications	Input required	Exam and training cost: input required	Shared across offerings

Note: Deals to pay back = build cost ÷ (first-deal fee × margin %). Example: 04 at $20k build and a $30k deal needs margin from Finance to complete.

FORMULA, INPUTS REQUIRED

Margin structure and revenue recognition per offering

Margin = price − (onshore days × cost + nearshore days × cost + offshore days × cost) − contingency − tools

Offering	Work that stays onshore	Work that can move offshore	Delivery mix	Revenue recognition (proposed)
04 Assessment	Workshops, memo readout	Data analysis, cost model	Input: delivery lead	Fixed price, on acceptance of memo
01 Landing Zone	Design authority, customer workshops	IaC build, testing	Input: delivery lead	Fixed-price milestones per gate
03 AI Gateway	Design, security review	Policy build, load tests	Input: delivery lead	Fixed-price milestones per gate
02 Agent Governance	Containment authority, drills	Catalogue build, adapters	Input: delivery lead	Milestones; stop-path pilot as a separate fixed fee
05 Managed Operations	Service lead, major incidents	Monitoring, changes, reports	Input: delivery lead	Monthly managed service fee

Decision: Rates, delivery costs and recognition rules are Finance decisions. Owner: Finance with the delivery lead.

ALLIANCE TEAM TO CONFIRM

Microsoft sellers to engage, and the consumption each drives

Offering	Microsoft solution area (FY26)	Microsoft roles to engage (indicative)	Consumption it drives
04 Assessment	Cloud and AI Platforms	Azure AI specialist, account team	Confident PTU and model purchases
01 Landing Zone	Cloud and AI Platforms	Azure specialist, cloud solution architect	Foundry, networking, monitoring
03 AI Gateway	Cloud and AI Platforms	Azure AI apps and agents specialist	API Management, model tokens
02 Agent Governance	Security; Cloud and AI Platforms	Security specialist, AI specialist	Agent 365, Defender, Purview, Foundry
05 Managed Operations	Cloud and AI Platforms	Account team, partner manager	Sustained production workloads

Decision: Packaged IP route: 04 cost model or 03 policy library as a Marketplace offer needs a certified software designation (decision D1).

Sign-off status: nobody has reviewed this yet

Reviewer	What they confirm	Status	Planned date
CIS Infra tower leads	Scope, effort, bench	Not yet reviewed	Input required
Security tower	Policy ownership, threat models, kill-switch authority	Not yet reviewed	Input required
Finance	Rates, margin, recognition, attribution	Not yet reviewed	Input required
Microsoft alliance team	Partner motion, specializations, funding	Not yet reviewed	Input required
M365 and D365 practice leads	Copilot split, joint-deal rules	Not yet reviewed	Input required
Legal	Contract positions, liability	Not yet reviewed	Input required
DevOps, AI and Data towers	RACI rows and support agreements	Not yet reviewed	Input required

How the portfolio is governed: owner, gates, cadence, stops

Validate
90 days

Exit: Qualified accounts, assets built, reviews signed

Pilot
about 6 months

Exit: First paid customers, actual effort captured

Launch
after pilot

Exit: External marketing, Marketplace if chosen

Governance item	Proposal
P&L owner	Input required: CIS Infra leadership
Monthly review	Offering owners with Finance: pipeline, effort, margin, risks
Quarterly gate	Leadership decides continue, change or stop per offering
Stop rule	Any offering that misses its gate exit stops or is re-scoped

INPUTS REQUIRED

Customer third-party risk: our proposed answers

Question area	Proposed answer
Where is customer data?	In the customer tenant and region; Cognizant holds no copies outside it
Who has access?	Named engineers through customer PIM, just-in-time, logged
Is AI content logged?	Counts and IDs only by default; content logging opt-in (deck 03 and 05)
Subcontractors	None planned; any change needs customer approval
Incident notification	Per contract; security incidents routed to the customer resolver
Certifications	Input required: Cognizant security and compliance office

Responsible AI: platform controls versus use-case controls

Principle	Platform control (CIS Infra implements)	Model or use-case control (owner)
Accountability	Agent registry, owner per agent, audit evidence	Business owner sign-off (customer)
Transparency	Logging of agent actions and versions	User disclosure, documentation (AI tower, customer)
Safety and security	Gateway safety filters, containment, private network	Red teaming, evaluations (AI tower, Security)
Privacy	Data stays in tenant; no content logging by default	Lawful basis, data minimisation (customer)
Fairness	Not a platform control	Evaluation and monitoring of outcomes (AI tower, customer)
Reliability	Capacity, routing, monitoring, recovery	Quality thresholds, human oversight (AI tower, customer)

INPUTS REQUIRED

Inputs we need from leadership and functions

Input	Owner	Needed for
Chosen offerings, sponsors, owners, P&L owner	CIS Infra leadership	Exec 10, A13
90-day budgets and headcount	CIS Infra leadership with Finance	Exec 10
Blended rates, delivery costs, margin targets, recognition	Finance	A10, every fee band
Target accounts and attach rates	Account leadership	A8 sizing
Bench numbers and delivery mix	CIS Infra delivery lead	DP1 in each deck, A10
Partner designations and funding eligibility	Microsoft alliance team	Exec 9, A11
Copilot split and joint-deal rules	M365 and D365 practice leads	Exec 6, A3
Certifications and contract positions	Compliance office, Legal	A14, contract slides

ESTIMATE, NOT APPROVED

How the effort and duration ranges were built

Package	Low case assumes	High case assumes
04 Assessment	20 days: telemetry exists, two workloads	40 days: no telemetry, six workloads
01 Establish	140 days: greenfield, one region	220 days: hub constraints, three regions
03 Build, one region	45 days: five consumers	90 days: twenty consumers, complex hub
02 Configure and pilot	45 days: two runtimes, licence owned	90 days: several clouds, no licence
05 Foundation	30 days a month: one environment	60 days a month: three environments

Basis and recalibration plan

Basis: 01 is anchored on the GTM proposal V3 worked example (88 role days); 02 to 05 are bottom-up author estimates by role and activity. Recalibrate after every pilot: record actual role days per package, compare with the band, and reset bands each quarter. Owner: integrated service owner with Finance.

PROPOSED TOOL

Qualification scorecard and account shortlist template

Criterion (score 0, 1 or 2)	Evidence
Funded workload	Named owner, budget route, decision date
Platform authority	Who can approve tenant and network changes
Executive sponsor	Named and engaged
Data access	Source owner and rights confirmed
Region and capacity	Model, deployment type and quota checked
Data residency gate	UK or Middle East in-country need checked (deck 01)
Regulated bank	Model risk and DORA position known
Microsoft context	Agent 365, E7 or Copilot plans known

Account shortlist (template, empty)

Account	Sponsor	Workload	Blocker	Score	Next action

Decision: Quote implementation at 14+ with no zero on funding, authority, sponsor or residency. Otherwise sell the assessment.

AI threat model: what can go wrong, and who controls it

Threat	Example	Control	Owner
Prompt injection	Malicious text in a document or tool result	Content safety, prompt shields, tool-side validation	Security, AI tower
MCP tool trust boundary	Agent calls an unapproved MCP server	API Center allow-list, gateway-only routing (03)	Security with CIS Infra
Supply chain	Compromised model, package or connector	Approved catalogues, image scanning, pinned versions	DevOps, Security
Agent identity misuse	Agent token used outside its scope	Entra agent identities, Conditional Access for agents	Security
Excessive agency	Agent acts beyond its mandate	Runtime limits, approvals, containment (02)	AI tower, CIS Infra
Unbounded consumption	Runaway agent burns tokens	Token quotas, budgets, alerts (03, 04)	CIS Infra, budget owner
Sensitive data disclosure	Personal data in prompts or logs	Purview, no content logging by default	Security

CHECKED 11 OCT 2026

NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Regulation: who holds which duty, and where we help

Party	Likely EU AI Act role (indicative)	What this offering supports
Customer deploying AI systems	Deployer (usually)	Inventory, logging and oversight evidence (02, 05)
Customer building its own AI system	Provider	Platform controls and technical documentation inputs (01, 03)
Cognizant CIS Infra	Usually neither: infrastructure service provider	Role stated in the contract; Legal confirms

Area	Checkpoint	Status (checked 11 Oct 2026)
EU AI Act	Annex III high-risk duties from 2 Dec 2027; Annex I from 2 Aug 2028	Third-party summary (Orrick); EUR-Lex not verified
EU DORA	ICT risk and ICT third-party contract terms for financial entities	Applies from 17 Jan 2025 (EUR-Lex)
EU NIS2	Cyber risk management for essential and important entities	National laws; deadline 17 Oct 2024
UK	Regulator-led AI principles; UK GDPR	Not re-verified: confirm current position
UAE	Federal Decree-Law 45 of 2021 (personal data)	Executive regulations: verify status
Saudi Arabia	PDPL (enforceable Sep 2024); NCA cloud controls CCC-1:2020	Third-party summary; verify transfer rules
US banks	Interagency model risk guidance (17 Apr 2026) replaced SR 11-7	Generative and agentic AI out of scope; governance still expected

CHECKED 11 OCT 2026

Security services: Security owns policy, we wire them in

Service	Role in AI security	Owner	Status (checked 11 Oct 2026)
Defender for Cloud AI threat protection	Alerts on jailbreak, data leakage, credential theft for Foundry and Azure OpenAI models	Security tower	GA; text tokens only
Purview DSPM (and DSPM for AI)	Data security posture for Copilot, Copilot Studio, Foundry and third-party AI apps	Security with Data	Mixed current and preview
Microsoft Sentinel	SIEM correlation of AI, identity and gateway signals	Security tower	GA (not re-verified)
Entra Agent ID and Conditional Access for agents	Agent identities; block or limit agent access	Security designs, CIS Infra implements	Microsoft 365 E7, or Agent 365 with Entra P1 or E3
Content Safety and Prompt Shields	Prompt-attack and harm filtering at gateway or model	CIS Infra configures, Security sets policy	GA (via APIM policy)
Agent 365 policies	Registry, agent policies, lifecycle (announced)	Security accountable; CIS Infra configures	GA 1 May 2026

Decision: Security is accountable for policy on these services. CIS Infra is responsible for implementation and telemetry.

Glossary of terms used in this deck

Term	Meaning
A2A	Agent-to-agent protocol for agents calling other agents
Agent 365	Microsoft control plane to register, observe and govern agents (per-user licence)
API Center	Azure registry for APIs and MCP servers; decides which tools exist
APIM	Azure API Management; the gateway that controls traffic
Copilot Studio	Microsoft low-code tool to build agents; consumption in Copilot credits
Data Zone	Model processing inside a Microsoft data zone (US, EU or APAC)
DORA	EU Digital Operational Resilience Act for financial entities
FOCUS	FinOps Open Cost and Usage Specification for cost data exports

Term	Meaning
Foundry	Microsoft Foundry: Azure platform for models and agents
FTE	Full-time equivalent person
MCP	Model Context Protocol: standard way for agents to call tools
MRM	Model risk management (banking supervision)
NIS2	EU directive on cybersecurity for essential sectors
PAYG	Pay as you go: pay per token used
PDPL	Personal Data Protection Law (Saudi Arabia, UAE)
PIM	Entra Privileged Identity Management: just-in-time admin access

Term	Meaning
PTU	Provisioned throughput unit: reserved model capacity, billed per hour
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed
RFP	Request for proposal
RTO / RPO	Recovery time objective / recovery point objective
SOW	Statement of work
Token	Unit of text a model reads or writes; the main pricing unit
TPM	Tokens per minute

Decisions that need an owner and a date

Decision	Decide when	Proposed owner	Evidence needed
Which offerings to test (one, several or all five)	Now	CIS Infra leadership	Exec 4 and 10
Sponsor, owner, budget and headcount per chosen offering	Now	CIS Infra leadership, Finance	Exec 10
M365 versus D365 split of Copilot ownership	Within 30 days	M365 and D365 practice leads	Account coverage
Joint-deal lead and revenue credit rules	Within 30 days	Practice leads with Finance	A3
Rates, margin and revenue recognition	Finance approval	Finance	A10
Specialization and co-sell route	Before first quote	Microsoft alliance team	Exec 9, A11
Packaged IP route (Marketplace)	After pilot	CIS Infra leadership	A11
External launch	After pilot gate	CIS Infra leadership	A13

Sources and verification

Microsoft Agent 365 now generally available (Microsoft Security blog, 1 May 2026): https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/05/01/microsoft-agent-365-now-generally-available-expands-capabilities-and-integrations/

Foundry Models retirement schedule: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/foundry/openai/concepts/model-retirement-schedule

EU AI Act Update: Digital Omnibus finalises compliance changes (Orrick, third-party law-firm summary, 29 Jul 2026; EUR-Lex text not verified): https://www.orrick.com/en/Insights/2026/07/EU-AI-Act-Update-Digital-Omnibus-Finalizes-8-Compliance-Changes

Regulation (EU) 2022/2554 (DORA), EUR-Lex: https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2022/2554/oj

Directive (EU) 2022/2555 (NIS2), EUR-Lex: https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/dir/2022/2555/oj

Saudi Arabia key data and cybersecurity laws (Baker McKenzie, third party, reviewed 31 Dec 2024): https://resourcehub.bakermckenzie.com/en/resources/global-data-and-cyber-handbook/emea/saudi-arabia/topics/key-data-and-cybersecurity-laws

Banking regulators replace SR 11-7 with revised model risk guidance (JD Supra law-firm summary, third party): https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/banking-regulators-replace-5649360/

Register and discover MCP servers in Azure API Center: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/api-center/register-discover-mcp-server

Services co-sell (Microsoft Learn, Partner Center): https://learn.microsoft.com/partner-center/services-co-sell

Specializations (Microsoft Learn, Partner Center, updated 29 Sep 2026): https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/partner-center/membership/specializations-apply

What's new for partners, Jan 2026 (Microsoft Partner blog): https://partner.microsoft.com/blog/article/whats-new-for-partners-jan-2026

Azure AI Landing Zones (GitHub): https://github.com/Azure/AI-Landing-Zones

Conditional Access for agents (Microsoft Learn, updated 30 Sep 2026): https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/identity/conditional-access/agent-id

Sources and verification (continued)

AI threat protection in Microsoft Defender for Cloud: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/defender-for-cloud/ai-threat-protection

Microsoft Purview data security and compliance for AI: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/ai-microsoft-purview

OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications 2026 (OWASP GenAI Security Project, released 3 Aug 2026): https://genai.owasp.org/resource/owasp-genai-llm-top-10-2026/

ISO/IEC 42001 AI management systems: https://www.iso.org/standard/81230.html

CIS Infra Azure AI Platform GTM Proposal V3 (competitor benchmark and Cognizant sources C1 to C9, reviewed 7 Oct 2026): https://github.com/upendra25312/AI-Foundry-GTM-offering-/blob/main/CIS_Infra_Azure_AI_Platform_GTM_Proposal_V3.docx

Deck 01 to 05 v4.0 source registers: See S1 in each deck